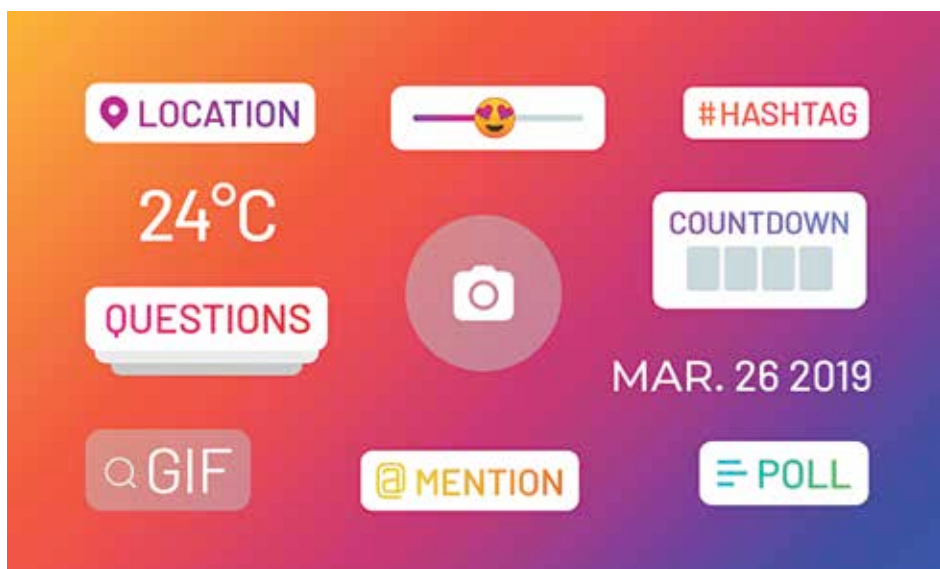




Up your Instagram stories game

Some lesser-known Instagram story hacks to put you on the map

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THERE'S SOMETHING IN-NATELY ENTICING ABOUT INSTAGRAM STORIES.

They're a powerful outlet for content creators, and even the general user base, to express their creativity and share moments of their lives. The primary idea behind Instagram stories was simple, it was an outlet for people to share their 'moments' conveniently and quickly. However, it has quickly transformed into something much more powerful, if used right. It can catapult the success of brands, social media marketers, influencers, celebrities and even make people ridiculously popular by sharing simple, yet well-thought-out

and executed content. If you want to up your Instagram stories game to put yourself or your brand on the map, here's a few lesser-known Insta-story hacks.

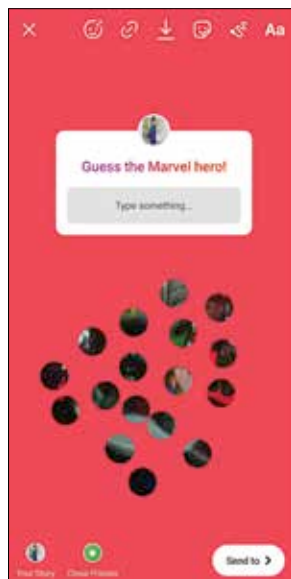


CREATE 'HYPE' STORIES

The saying goes "Curiosity killed the cat", however, in the social media-driven world we live in, we should say "Curiosity roped in followers". Creating a certain shroud of mystery around your posts and stories can be infinitely useful in attracting attention and retaining it for the long haul. This is why you probably see a ton of influencers creating stories with 'hype' for their next post, story or giveaway. One example is, say you've bought a new phone and you are going to be putting up a post revealing your spanking new gadget. You could grab the attention of users by putting up an 'Instagram Question' story and ask them to guess what

new phone you've bought. This will usually ensure that your followers make the trip back to your profile to check what you actually purchased because curiosity is a powerful driving force.

Another way to do this is by uploading the image you're going to be posting



Generate curiosity and hype around stories and future posts.

soon as a story and then clicking on the Paint tool (looks like a squiggly line) on the top right of the screen. Now, select a colour from the bottom and simply tap and hold your photo. The entire screen will now be filled with the bold colour you have chosen. Now, simply pick the 'Eraser' tool and draw a few dots or lines over the images, which will only partially reveal the image. You can ask your followers to stay tuned and check your page to see the reveal soon, which boosts post engagement.



TURN LIVE PHOTOS INTO BOOMERANGS

The Live Photos feature is a nifty one, however, it is mostly overlooked due to the extra space it consumes and because they're merely short videos. Until now. Instagram can let you turn these Live Photos into Boomerangs! Sadly, this feature can be only used on iOS Live Photos and not on say, Samsung's Motion Photos.

There's one small caveat though before you can go ahead creating your Boomerangs out of your Live Photos. The Live Photo on your camera roll must be less than 24 hours old. To make these Live-Photo-Boomerangs, simply open Instagram stories and pick a Live Photo from your camera roll. Next, press and hold the Live Photo on the Instagram story screen for a few seconds until you see the word 'Boomerang' appear fleetingly. And, that's it. Your Live Photo is now a Boomerang ready to share.



VEIL YOUR HASHTAGS

While hashtags in stories certainly boost your reach, they can seriously deter-